RE: Tonie Greve

From Lee, Candace S. (IHS/PHX) <Candace.Lee@ihs.gov>

To Kevin Turnage MSN Ed. RN<Kevin.Turnage@ihs.gov>, Kevin Turnage<kdturnage@protonmail.com>, White, Jason (IHS/PHX/PIMC)<Jason.White@ihs.gov>

CC Patton, George W (IHS/PHX)<George.Patton@ihs.gov>, Dickerson, Angela M. (IHS/PHX)<Angela.Dickerson@ihs.gov>, Pingel, Todd (IHS/PHX)<Todd.Pingel@ihs.gov>, IHSDMEEOStaff@ihs.gov, EEO Complaints and Adjudication<EEOComplaint-Adjud@ihs.gov>, Sims, Debra (IHS/HQ)<Debra.Sims@ihs.gov>

Date Wednesday, August 31st, 2022 at 8:24 AM

Kevin,

I would like to meet to discuss your concerns this afternoon. Are you available at 2:30?

Thank you,

Candace

So noted, I notified employees who stated they would continue with their complaint for the agencies failure to prevent harassment and a hostile work environment. It appears the agency is not concerned about protecting other employees and is not willing to enforce our own policies or Federal Law. I want to go on record as the supervisor of record to say that I feel this is a blatant disregard for the safety of these employees and condones the harassing and hostile environment for these employees. I feel it is in direct conflict with the Indian Health Manual and the stated Zero Tolerance policy. It also causes me to fail in being able to comply with 1-16.3 B, which states that all supervisors and managers are responsible for:

1. Taking appropriate actions to prevent harassment in the workplace, and when appropriate, to assist in providing a prompt, thorough and impartial management inquiry of harassment allegations.
2. Taking immediate steps to address complaints of harassment reported by employees.
3. Taking steps to prevent retaliation against employees who complain of harassment, or who assist in conducting inquiries.
4. Protecting the confidentiality of employees who allege or report harassment, to the extent possible.
5. Providing interim relief to alleged victims of harassment to the extent possible, on a case by case basis, pending the outcome of a management inquiry, union grievance, or EEO complaint to ensure that further misconduct does not occur.

I feel like am being prevented from preventing harassment and restrained by management for trying to take appropriate action against the employee to move her out of the department during the investigation, as is standard and past practice in these types of situations. I feel the agency is preventing me from being able to ensure that the employees are provided the opportunity to work in a hostile free environment. These complaints started well before my arrival and some of the complainants made Angie Dickerson and Carolyn Tapahe aware as well, I was notified during my detail in August of last year and I notified my leadership when the detail was ended a few days later. These individuals have tolerated more than most reasonable individuals would have done at this point with the agency not even investigating until this year even though management was notified.

V/r

Hon. Kevin Turnage MSN Ed. RN, AMB-BC, NHDP-BC, NPD-BC

"I am not authorized to obligate the government for any work, service or product. Please do not perform any work that will require payment without a valid contract, issued by a government Contracting Officer. Changes to a contract can only be made by the contracting officer. Contractors are reminded to promptly notify the contracting officer of any conduct that may be regarded as a change to the contract in accordance with FAR52-243-7"

From: White, Jason (IHS/PHX/PIMC) <Jason.White@ihs.gov>
Sent: Tuesday, August 30, 2022 1:17 PM
To: Turnage, Kevin D. (IHS/PHX) <Kevin.Turnage@ihs.gov>; Lee, Candace S. (IHS/PHX) <Candace.Lee@ihs.gov>
Cc: Patton, George W (IHS/PHX) <George.Patton@ihs.gov>; Dickerson, Angela M. (IHS/PHX) <Angela.Dickerson@ihs.gov>
Subject: RE: Tonie Greve

Hello,

I deeply appreciate the dedication to safety for your team. After further consideration, at the time the complaint was issued up to today, it was determined that it would not be best to detail Ms. Greve, given the other personal matter that also came forward. At this time unless directed by ER/LR I cannot move forward with a detail as I'm concerned it might be perceived as retaliation.

From: Turnage, Kevin D. (IHS/PHX) <Kevin.Turnage@ihs.gov>
Sent: Monday, August 29, 2022 7:20 AM
To: Lee, Candace S. (IHS/PHX) <Candace.Lee@ihs.gov>; White, Jason (IHS/PHX/PIMC) <Jason.White@ihs.gov>

Cc: Patton, George W (IHS/PHX) <George.Patton@ihs.gov>; Dickerson, Angela M. (IHS/PHX) <Angela.Dickerson@ihs.gov>
Subject: Tonie Greve

Please see attached detail letter to Tonie Greve to detail her out of primary care until the investigation of the hostile work environment complaints are completed. These complaints were brought to the agencies attention on July 27, 2022 some 32 days ago. These investigations are supposed to be completed within 15 days and this has not occurred. In the past I have requested that Ms. Greve be transferred out during the investigation and was told it could not be done. Now I have received a formal complaint the agency has failed to prevent continued harassment and retaliation towards the complainants. The EEOC states an employer will be liable for harassment by non-supervisory employees or non-employees over whom it has control, if it knew, or should have known about the harassment and failed to take prompt and appropriate corrective action. I am just trying to ensure that as supervisor to all 4 of these employees that I am on records trying to take preventative action while the investigation is ongoing, by detailing her we prevent further issues for failure to reasonably try to prevent and promptly correct the harassing environment. Especially since when investigating allegations of harassment, the EEOC looks at the entire record including the nature of the conduct, and the context in which the alleged incidents occurred. A determination of whether harassment is severe or pervasive enough to be illegal is made on a case-by-case basis. They also look to see if the employer unreasonably failed to take advantage of any preventive or corrective opportunities. Please provide the information requested (highlighted in attached detail letter) as to mitigate any further issues.

Hon. Kevin D. Turnage MSN Ed. RN-BC, NHDP- BC

Supervisory Clinical Nurse PCMC,

Phoenix Indian Medical Center

602-263-1574

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From: Turnage, Kevin D. (IHS/PHX) <Kevin.Turnage@ihs.gov>
Sent: Tuesday, August 30, 2022 3:12 PM
To: White, Jason (IHS/PHX/PIMC) <Jason.White@ihs.gov>; Lee, Candace S. (IHS/PHX) <Candace.Lee@ihs.gov>
Cc: Patton, George W (IHS/PHX) <George.Patton@ihs.gov>; Dickerson, Angela M. (IHS/PHX)

<Angela.Dickerson@ihs.gov>; Pingel, Todd (IHS/PHX) <Todd.Pingel@ihs.gov>; IHS DMEEO Staff <IHSDMEEOStaff@ihs.gov>; EEO Complaints and Adjudication <EEOComplaint-Adjud@ihs.gov>; Sims, Debra (IHS/HQ) <Debra.Sims@ihs.gov>
Subject: RE: Tonie Greve
Importance: High